

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 8 6 4

♥ 9 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ 9 4

♠ 5 2

♥ A 7 3

♦ K 10 4 3

♣ K J 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 3

♥ J 10 8 5

♦ J 6

♣ Q 10 8 7 3

♠ A 10 9

♥ K Q 6 4

♦ A 9 5 2

♣ A 5

West

2 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

North

Pass

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

Partner's 1NT overcall shows 15-18 points and guarantees a ♠ stop. With 11 points and no 4-card ♥ suit you say 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠ K. Do you hold up or not?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 8

You need just one more winner. It could come from a finesse of the ♣ J. It could come from a 3-3 ♥ split. It could come by establishing a fourth card in ♦ s.

Most important for now is the ♠ lead? Do you hold up?

Yes you should hold up. In fact you might as well hold up twice since you aren't contemplating a throw-in of West. Holding up twice will protect you in the unlikely event that West made his 2 ♠ bid with a 5-card suit.

Both the ♥ possibility and the ♣ possibility will either work or not, so you can save them for later. Your highest percentage chance is the fourth ♦, but here you must be careful. You must try to establish the ♦ s without allowing West to get the lead. It is actually pretty easy. Just play a small ♦ from your hand and when West plays low insert the ♦ 10. East wins the ♦ J but cannot harm you with his return.

When the remaining ♦ s fall you have established your ninth trick.

Suppose West inkles out what you are trying to do and inserts his ♦ Q when you play the low ♦ toward dummy?

If he does that he hands you all four ♦ tricks!

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 5
 ♥ K 10 4
 ♦ J 10 9 5
 ♣ J 7 4

♠ J 9 8 6 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 6 2

♣ A Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7

♥ Q J 9 6 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ K 10 5 3

♠ A 10 2

♥ A 8

♦ A K 7 3

♣ 9 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠		
All Pass			

3♠ by South and another ♠ you could go down. Remember that you only counted one ♥ loser - that means you MUST ruff a ♥ in your hand.

Win the ♦ lead and play ♥ A and another ♥ before you touch trumps.

After this there is nothing the defense can do to stop you ruffing one ♥ in your hand.

Just suppose for an instant that you had played ♠ A and another.

West would have taken the second ♠, then pulled your last ♠. When the ♣ finesse failed you would make only 8 tricks.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer; you respond 2♠.

Partner now bids 3♠.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer; you respond 2♠.

Partner now bids 3♠.

Partner tells you that he has only invitational strength, but has at least 6 ♠s. The ♠s are fine by you, but with only 15 HCP you decide to pass.

South plays 3♠. West leads the ♦ J. UhOh. Maybe you should have bid game.

Loser List: ♠ = ? : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = ?

If the ♠s are 2-2 there will be only one loser in that suit. And maybe the ♣ finesse will work.

Don't get too optimistic too early. If you play ♠ A

Board 5

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 4
♥ A 10 9 8
♦ Q J 10 8
♣ J 8 3

♠ K Q 8 6 3
♥ 6 2
♦ K 7 3
♣ K 6 2



♠ J 9 5 2
♥ Q J 5
♦ 9 2
♣ 10 9 7 4

♠ A 10
♥ K 7 4 3
♦ A 6 5 4
♣ A Q 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			